

Discussion Section

HIST-103 | The Emergence of Modern Europe

Instructor: Dr. Lindsay O'Neill

Term: Fall 2026

Assignment Summary

Grade weight:	15%
Start date:	2026-11-10
Due date:	2026-11-12
Group project:	Yes

Overview (Assignments section)

This section of your grade is determined by your participation in your discussion section. Your TA will outline their participation policies in section. Part of your participation grade is to complete two primary source activities on Nov 13 and Nov 20 (posted on Brightspace like a reading). These should be turned into your TA's link on their Brightspace page before section begins for credit. It will be graded pass/fail. See your TA's syllabus for more information.

Related Mentions

- This section of your grade is determined by your participation in your discussion section. Your TA will outline their participation policies in section. Part of your participation grade is to complete two primary source activities on Nov 13 and Nov 20 (posted on Brightspace like a reading). These should be turned into your TA's link on their Brightspace page before section begins for credit. It will be graded pass/fail. See your TA's syllabus for more information.
- the rise of print. They will be familiar with writers, artists, practitioners, thinkers, groups,
- and leaders who were part of these changes. They will analyze significant texts that are
- part of such a history from Pico della Mirandola to Locke and Rosseau; and understand the
- continuity between the past examples of a tradition and their later manifestations,
- Office Hours
- Instructor: Teaching Assistants:
- Dr. Lindsay O'Neill 8am & 9am Discussion Sections
- Office: SOS 255 Emily Kuwaye (kuwaye@usc.edu)
- ljoneill@usc.edu 10am & 11am Discussion Sections
- Office Hours: TTh 2:30-3:30pm or by appt Milena Kagel (kagel@usc.edu)
- Course Requirements & Expectations
- Course Requirements and Expectations:
- Attendance & Absences: Your presence both in lecture and in your discussion

- section is important. You will be tested on material from both and attending them
- all will enrich your class experience. There is no hybrid option for either lectures or
- discussion. I also do not post the powerpoints. However, if you miss something,
- I'm happy to go over it with you. Do contact me if you are struggling or if there are
- extenuating circumstances. I cannot help if I do not know there is a problem and I
- do want all my students to have a rewarding experience.
- Classroom Norms & Content Warning: In class we want to create an inclusive
- environment where everyone feels safe sharing ideas. Be respectful of other's ideas
- and remember that the goal is not to be right but to discuss and learn. Also be
- aware that this class covers some sensitive areas (as all history does). I will try to
- note when disturbing issues will arise, but I do not always know what is triggering.
- If you think certain issues might trigger you let me know so I can take a close look
- at the readings and assignments for you.
- Make-ups and Extensions: Getting an assignment in on time is your responsibility.
- If you think you will have a problem getting a paper in on time, contact your TA
- seen these all happen. Please don't do it. It makes me sad. If you have questions
- please see me.
- AI Generators: Since developing analytical, and critical thinking skills are part of
- the learning outcomes of this course, all assignments should be prepared by
- students working individually. Students may not have another person or entity
- complete any substantive portion of the assignment. Developing strong
- competencies in these areas will prepare you for a competitive workplace.
- Therefore, using AI-generated tools is prohibited in this course, will be identified
- as plagiarism, and will be reported to the Office of Academic Integrity unless it is
- included in your section policy as allowable. We also reserve the right to use AI
- detectors if we suspect the use of AI. We are aware that such detectors can be
- wrong but they can be one tool for us if we suspect AI use.
- Course Content Distribution and Synchronous Session Recordings Policies: USC
- has policies that prohibit recording and distribution of any synchronous and
- asynchronous course content outside of the learning environment. Recording a
- university class without the express permission of the instructor and announcement
- to the class, or unless conducted pursuant to an Office of Student Accessibility
- Services (OSAS) accommodation. Recording can inhibit free discussion in the
- future, and thus infringe on the academic freedom of other students as well as the
- instructor. (The USC Student Handbook, page 13). Distribution or use of notes,
- recordings, exams, or other intellectual property, based on university classes or

- lectures without the express permission of the instructor for purposes other than
- individual or group study. This includes but is not limited to providing materials for
- distribution by services publishing course materials. This restriction on
- unauthorized use also applies to all information, which had been distributed to
- students or in any way had been displayed for use in relationship to the class,
- whether obtained in class, via email, on the internet, or via any other media. (The
- USC Student Handbook, page 13).
- Support Systems for Writing: If you are worried about your writing skills you can
- see me or your TA, but if you want more help you can use USC's writing center.
- You can set up consultations to discuss writing strategies.
- Office of Student Accessibility Services: The Office of Student Accessibility
- Services (OSAS) provides certification for students who need accessibility services
- and helps arrange the relevant accommodations. A letter verifying your needs can
- be obtained from OSAS and should be forwarded to me as soon as possible.
- Emergency Support System: If an officially declared emergency makes travel to
- campus infeasible, USC Emergency Information will provide safety and other
- updates, including ways in which instruction will be continued by means of
- Brightspace, teleconferencing, and other technology.
- Required Readings
- Course Readings:
- If you didn't opt out of the new course adoption program, everything should be
- available online through either the readings I posted or through My Materials on
- Brightspace. Click here for the FAQ page. If you decided not to sign up for the
- digital course materials program you will need to buy the books below:
- Barbara Diefendorf, ed., The Saint Bartholomew's Day Massacre: A Brief History
- with Documents
- Assignments
- Assignments:
- Discussion Section - 15%
- This section of your grade is determined by your participation in your discussion
- section. Your TA will outline their participation policies in section. Part of your
- participation grade is to complete two primary source activities on Nov 13 and Nov
- 20 (posted on Brightspace like a reading). These should be turned into your TA's
- link on their Brightspace page before section begins for credit. It will be graded
- pass/fail. See your TA's syllabus for more information.
- Identification Quizzes - 5%

- After every lecture there will be three terms listed. Eleven times during the course of
- the semester there will be a quiz at the beginning of class that asks you to identify
- two of those terms. This exercise will prepare you for the exams, which will ask you
- 103.Levack.42
- PDF document
- 103.Levack.43
- PDF document
- 103.Levack.44
- PDF document
- 103.Levack.46
- PDF document
- 103.Levack.47
- PDF document
- Nov 10-13: Enlightenment
- Nov 10: Absolute Power: Experiments in Rule
- Witchcraft Paper Due
- Nov 12: The Enlightenment: Thought Experiments
- Nov 13: Readings for Section
- Excerpt: John Locke, Two Treatises of Government (1689)
- Excerpt: Rousseau, The Social Contract (1762)
- Enlightenment Primary Source Activity [Ungraded, but counts towards participation.
- Be sure to explain how your evidence connects to your main point (analyze it). Say
- why this quote or fact supports what you are arguing in that paragraph.
- know from outside of class, since we are testing you on what you learned in class. Using
- specific examples is always good. Since you have these questions before hand you should
- take the time to consider your answers: be sure that your essay has an argument that you
- support with examples and that it is written in essay form. Each body paragraph should
- have two examples to support the point it is making.
- If Martin Luther travelled through time to around the time of the French Revolution
- what would shock him and what would remain familiar? What does this tell us
- Your essay grade will benefit from specific references to the class readings. Use the
- documents from Diefendorf, reference the documentaries and the witchcraft trials,
- use Locke, and Rousseau and your activities.
- Avoid using the definitions we give in the id terms for your essay. If you show
- original engagement with the terms it's fine, but don't just say what I put down for
- the definitions. It doesn't show a deep engagement with the material and will most

- probably impact your grade.
- Your essay should have a thesis statement and each body paragraph should include
- at least two pieces of evidence to back up your point. We don't expect you to
- memorize quotes, but refer to specific people, texts, and events to support your
- argument. Be sure to let us know how those people, texts, and events support the
- point you want to make. Don't just write "like John Locke" tell use what Locke did
- to support your point.

Restrictions

- this paper. If you include other sources without checking with your TA you will be
- penalized.
- 103.Paper.2.F.26
- Word Document
- Nov 17-20: Enlightenment
- Nov 17: Living in "Enlightened" Europe
- Nov 19: Rumbles of Revolution
- Nov 20: Readings for Section
- Video: Africa & Britain, A Forgotten History, Episode 2: Freedom (50 min)
- Slavery and the African Presence in London Activity [Ungraded but counts towards
- participation. Due in section]
- 103.Act.Enslaved.F.26
- Word Document
- Nov 24 -27: Revolution
- Nov 24: You Say You Want a Revolution?: The French Revolution
- [If I have enough people who want an in-person lecture I will give one, but if you need to
- travel you should watch the below videos]
- The Fall of the French Monarchy (10 min)
- We are testing you on your ability to navigate the information provided for you by
- the class, not your ability to find more information. Avoid the internet and
- information from other courses.
- University Academic & Support Systems
- Statement on University Academic and Support Systems
- Students and Disability Accommodations:
- USC welcomes students with disabilities into all of the University's educational programs.
- The Office of Student Accessibility Services (OSAS) is responsible for the determination
- of appropriate accommodations for students who encounter disability-related barriers.

- Once a student has completed the OSAS process (registration, initial appointment, and submitted documentation) and accommodations are determined to be reasonable and appropriate, a Letter of Accommodation (LOA) will be available to generate for each course. The LOA must be given to each course instructor by the student and followed up with a discussion. This should be done as early in the semester as possible as accommodations are not retroactive. More information can be found at osas.usc.edu. You may contact OSAS at (213) 740-0776 or via email at osasfrontdesk@usc.edu.

Prompts (pick ONE)

- about what has changed between the Reformation and the French Revolution?
- How important was the written or printed word to the Reformation, the new science, the Enlightenment, and/or the French Revolution? What does this say about who was involved in discussions?
- True or False: "The French Revolution was the most revolutionary occurrence between 1520 and 1815." Be sure to consider what revolutionary means and compare it to at least two other "revolutionary" occurrences.
- Europe faced a number of crises of authority between 1520 and 1815 with the Reformation, the new science, absolute rule, the Enlightenment, and the French Revolution, among other tensions. What authorities were under attack and why?
- How did these crises change or not change European society? [Explore 3 crises]
- How did the place of religion OR gender in society change between 1520 and 1800?

Tips

- Know your ID Terms. These should be easy points, but if you miss a few they can impact your grade because it is hard to give partial credit.

Full Syllabus Extract

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can inhibit free discussion in the future, and thus infringe on the academic freedom of other students as well as the instructor. (The USC Student Handbook, page 13). Distribution or use of notes, recordings, exams, or other intellectual property, based on university classes or lectures without the express permission of the instructor for purposes other than individual or group study. This includes but is not limited to providing materials for distribution by services publishing course materials. This restriction on unauthorized use also applies to all information, which had been distributed to students or in any way had been displayed for use in relationship to the class, whether obtained in class, via email, on the internet, or via any other media. (The USC Student Handbook, page 13). Support Systems for Writing: If you are worried about your writing skills you can see me or your TA, but if you want more help you can use USC's writing center. You can set up consultations to discuss writing strategies.

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Be sure to explain how your evidence connects to your main point (analyze it). Say why this quote or fact supports what you are arguing in that paragraph. Do not search the Internet. We want you to just use Levack and maybe lecture for this paper. If you include other sources without checking with your TA you will be penalized. 103.Paper.2.F.26 Word Document Nov 17-20: Enlightenment Nov 17: Living in "Enlightened" Europe Nov 19: Rumbles of Revolution Nov 20: Readings for Section Video: Africa & Britain, A Forgotten History, Episode 2: Freedom (50 min) Slavery and the African Presence in London Activity [Ungraded but counts towards participation. Due in section] 103.Act.Enslaved.F.26 Word Document Nov 24 -27: Revolution Nov 24: You Say You Want a Revolution?: The French Revolution [If I have enough people who want an in-person lecture I will give one, but if you need to travel you should watch the below videos] The Fall of the French Monarchy (10 min)

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Locke, Two Treatises of Government (1689) Excerpt: Rousseau, The Social Contract (1762) Enlightenment Primary Source Activity [Ungraded, but counts towards participation. Due in section]